



**Berkeley**  
UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA

# CY PLAN 120

**Community Planning and  
Public Policy for Disability  
and Environmental Design**

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## Target Persona: Felipe Estrada

*Image was AI generated through Chat GPT*

### Key Attributes for Consideration:

- 41 years old
- Mestizo Miner
- Heart and lung issues -> 'crippled'
- Sunday mass, plaza
- "He would never work again" (Ladd, 1988).
- "Hardships specifically in terms of death and disability, ironically in terms of 'freedom'" (Ladd, 1988).
- Disability as an outsider, despite its deep connection

*( **Visual Description:** The image to the left shows an AI drawing of an Felipe Estrada with a grim expression on his face. He is sat on a chair in front of a church and plaza located in Real Del Monte. As a result of his mining days he has an amputated leg and a single wooden crutch.*





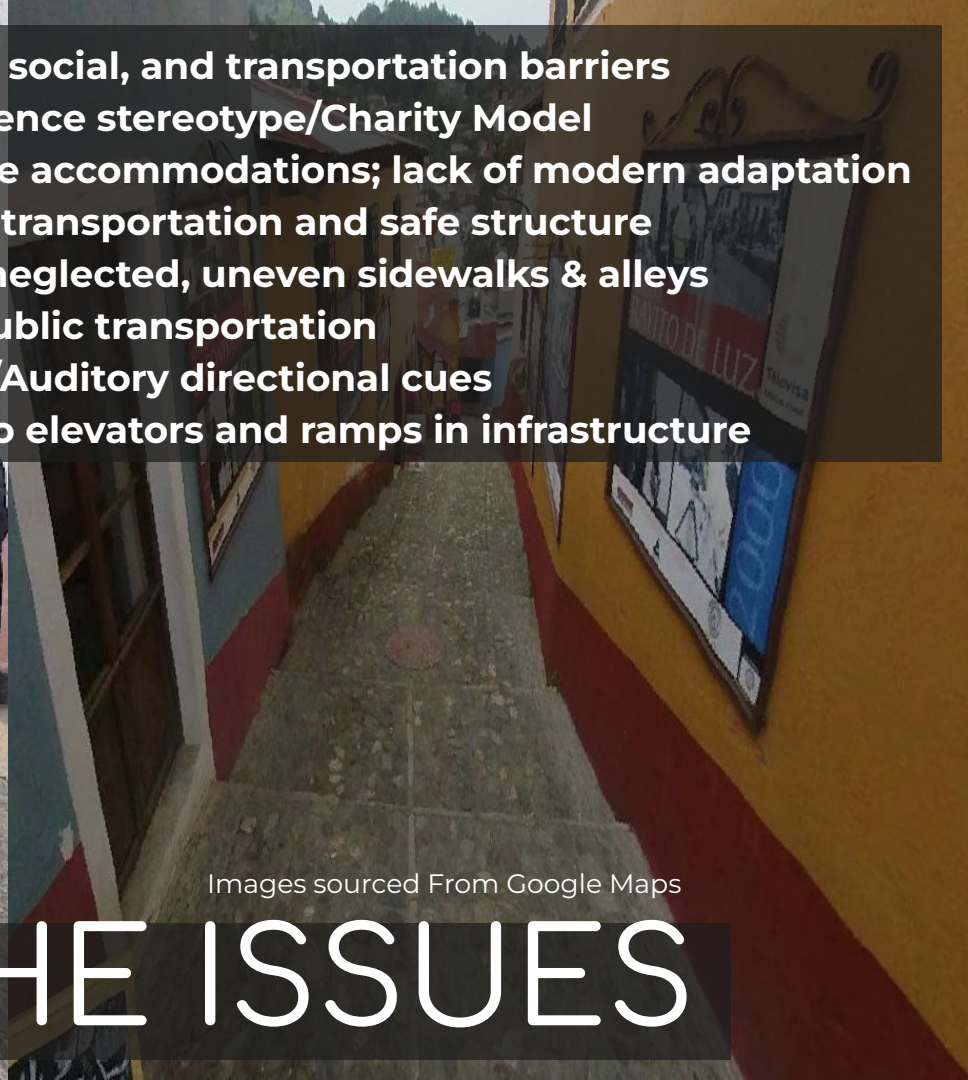
# Pachuca

- City within Hidalgo, Mexico
  - state's capital
- 2020 total population: 665,929, 52.3% women, 47.7% men
  - visual (15.8k)
  - physical (14.1k)
  - hearing (7.1k)
- Strong cultural ties and historical authenticity.
- Real Del Monte (east-central) is one of 84 municipalities
  - Avenida Hidalgo





- **Infrastructural, social, and transportation barriers**
  - **Independence stereotype/Charity Model**
- **Little accessible accommodations; lack of modern adaptation**
- **Lack of proper transportation and safe structure**
  - **Cracked, neglected, uneven sidewalks & alleys**
  - **Limited public transportation**
  - **No Visual/Auditory directional cues**
  - **Little to no elevators and ramps in infrastructure**



Images sourced From Google Maps

# WHAT ARE THE ISSUES



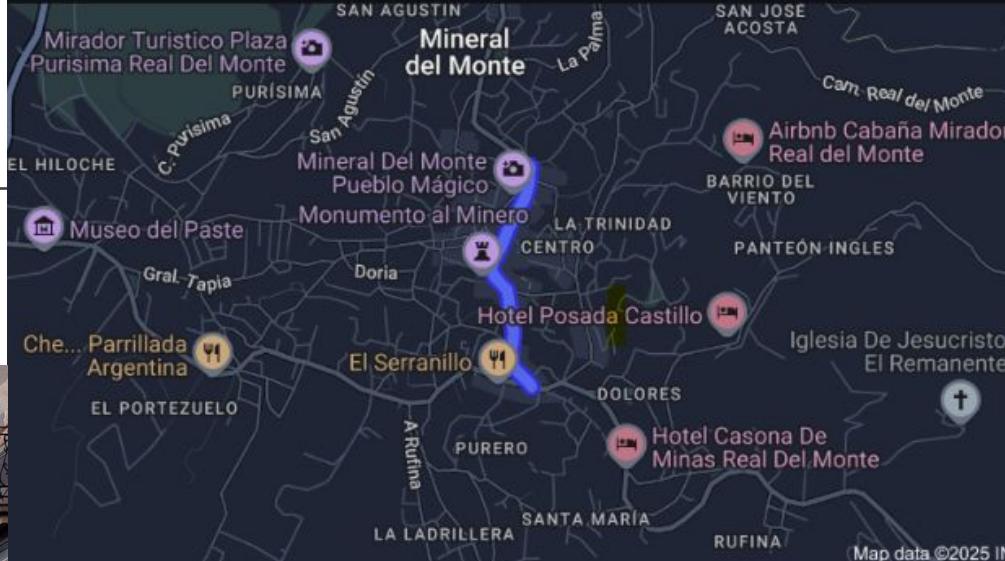
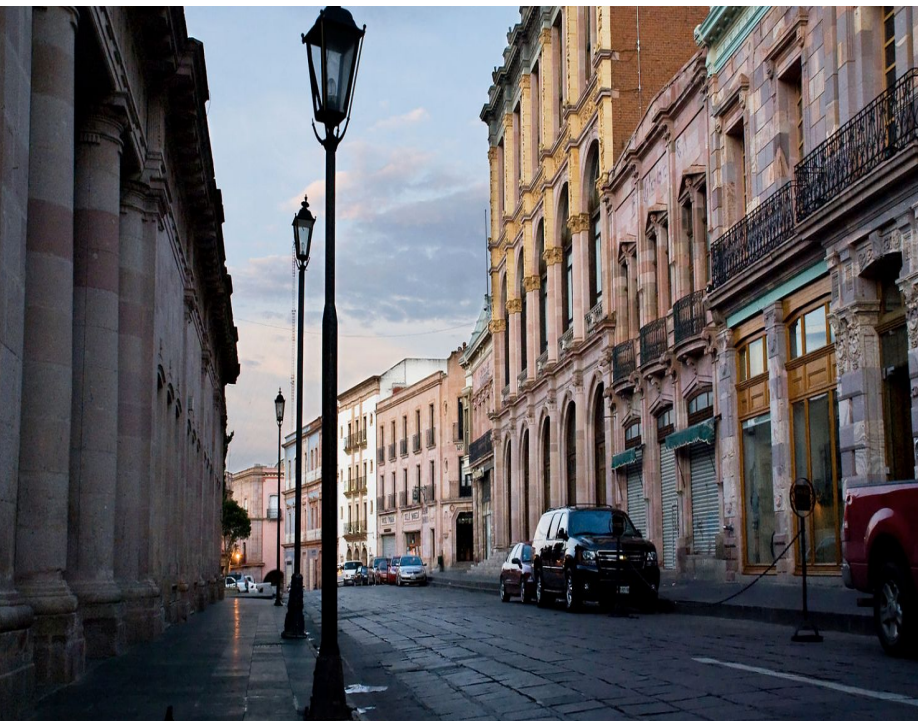
- **Lack** of usable space & importance
- **Cultivated** misunderstanding
- **Limited** resources and accommodations
- **Discrimination** and **ignorance** are a norm
- **Low degree** of participation in society because the structural context lacks adaptations



**Inequality should not be accepted!**

# Avenida Hidalgo

“Core Artery of Real del Monte”







## Image Sourced From Google Maps

Depicts a popular crossroads on Avenida Hidalgo where the terrain is uneven, the cross street is steep, the cobblestone streets are broken or cracked at places and the floor has different patterns at different parts, causing even more accessibility obstacles. The elevated sidewalks are very narrow and do not have curb cuts for easy access. Cars are parked very close to the sidewalks and could raise dangers for pedestrians. The image shows two pedestrians walking on the same road used by the cars.



**Avenida Hidalgo** - a street that serves as the **core artery** of Real del Monte- reinforces the exclusion of people with disabilities from **civic, cultural, and everyday community life** through its city planning and severe lack of universal design values



## Problem Statement

Image Sourced From Google Maps



# Avenue Redesign & Accessible Public Transportation

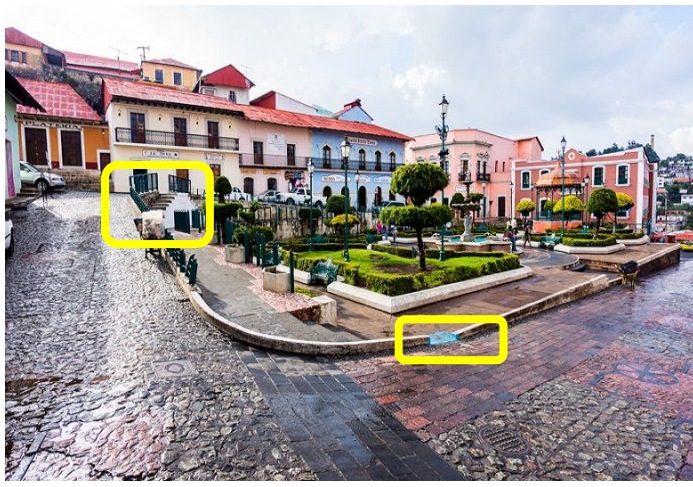
\* Propose a robust public transportation system to encourage participation from the public

- 1) Convenient accessible infrastructures on all transportation vehicles
- 2) Sidewalk reconstruction
- 3) Install more multisensory signage, warnings
- 4) Route design
- 5) Develop a transit app

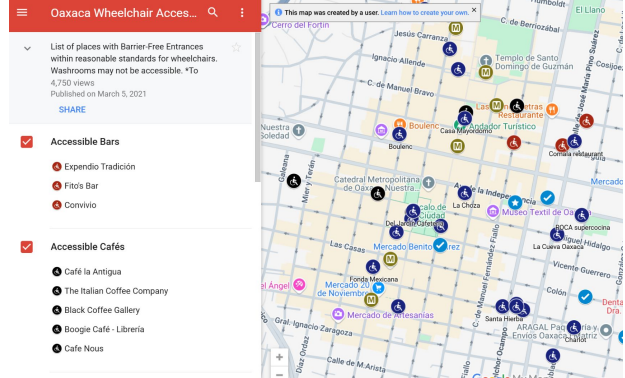
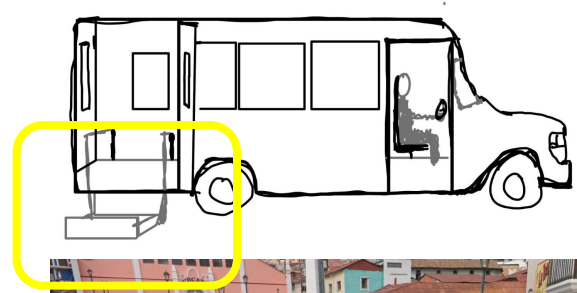
**Pros vs. Cons?**

Figures: Public Transportation in Mexico City





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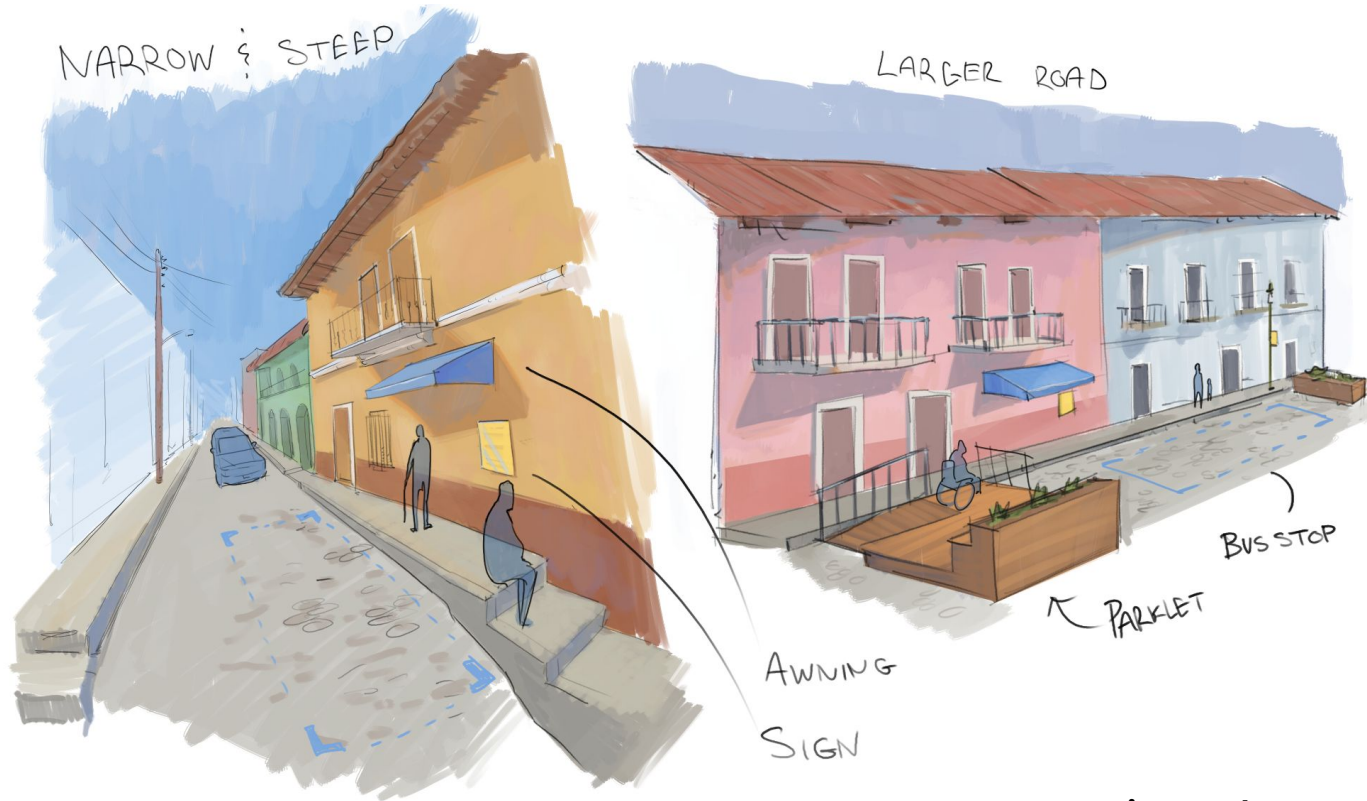


Accessible V. Inaccessible



# Bus Stop Implementation

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Limited Implementation

Intensive Implementation

## 1. Destination

Church  
Library  
Public park  
School  
Market  
Tourist sites  
Hospital  
Pharmacy

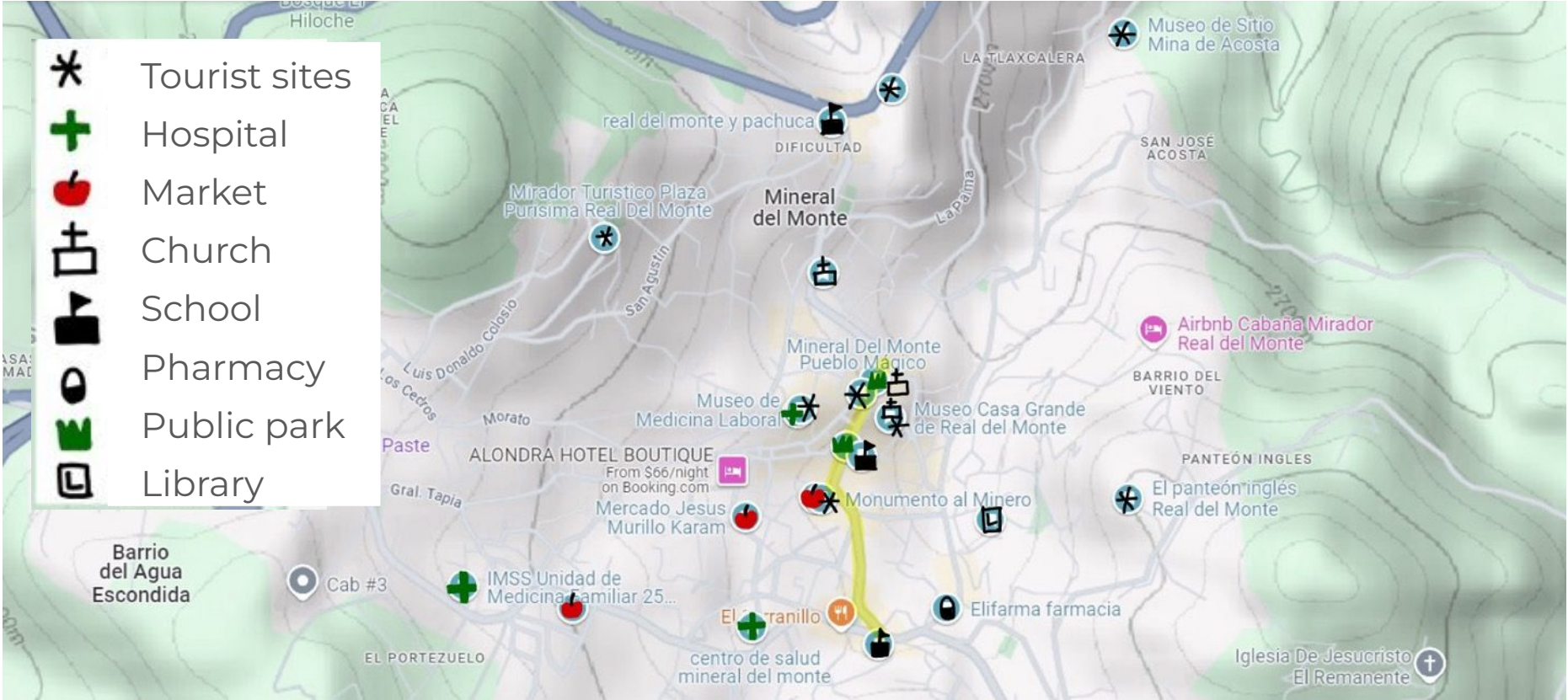
## 2. Mode of Transportation



A minibus suitable for narrow roads

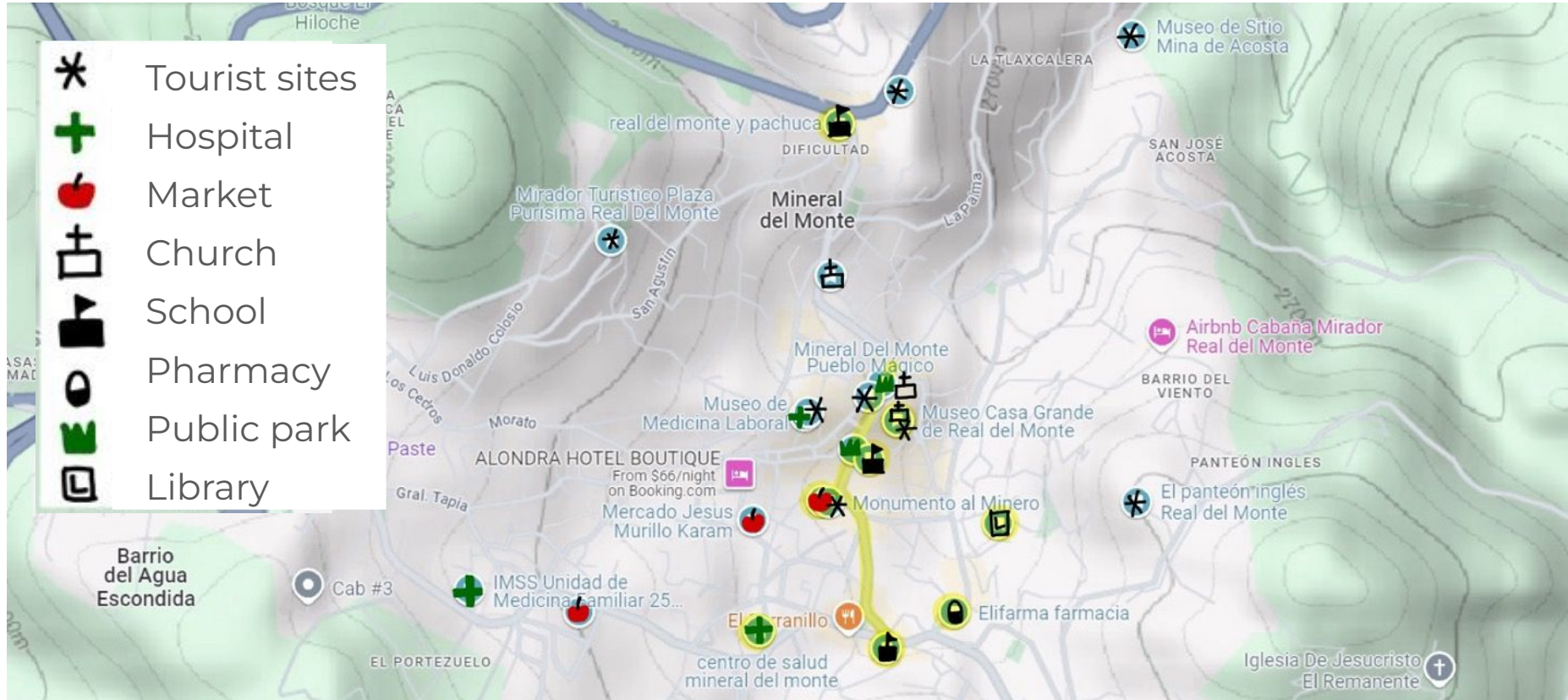


# 1. Spot some key destinations.



## 2. Highlight key destinations based on priority.

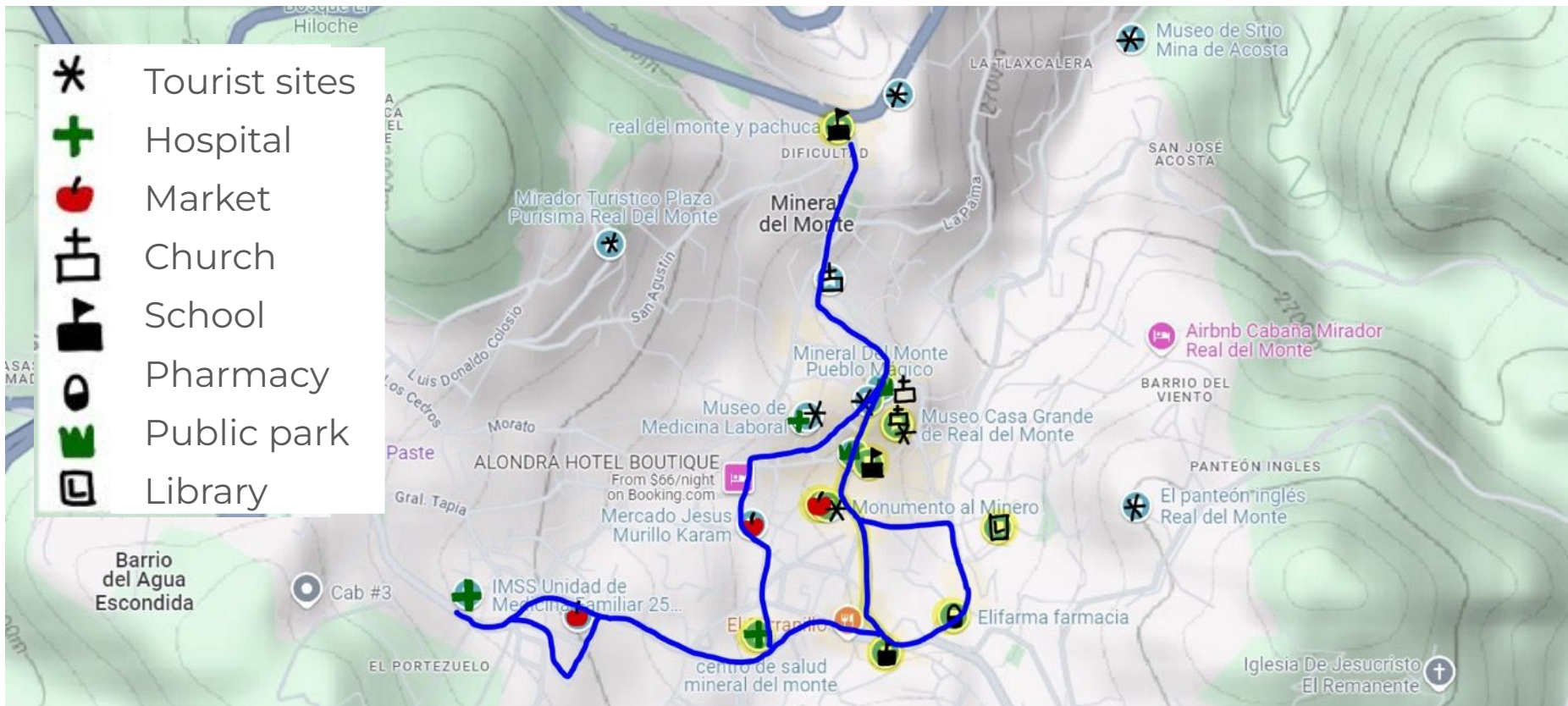
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### 3. Create a bus route considering road width.

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# Stakeholders and Funding

## Stakeholders:



## Funding Sources:





# Pillar 1: Legislative Measures

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## Mexico Legal Framework:

### National Level:

Mexico General Law for the Inclusion of People with Disabilities (2011)

Norma Oficial Mexicana (NOM) “Official Mexican Standard”

State Level: Law for the Care of People with Disabilities in the State of Hidalgo (1998)

Local Level: Pachuca-Plata Rotary Club Wheelchair Donation (2021)

City Council of Pachuca & Municipal President Sergio Baños

Proposal: Implementation of Accessible Public Transit System in Real del Monte

# Pillar 2: Executive Support & Leadership

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## Coalition Building & Advocacy

La Coalición Movilidad Segura (Safe Mobility Coalition)

Liga Peatonal (Pedestrian League)

Local Community  
(Peoples with Disabilities and Aging Deomgraphics)

## Adversary & Competing Interests

Local Business

Historical Preservationists

Financial Allocations and Alternative Priorities

Drivers



## Strategies & Appeals

Economic Interests

Local Cooperation and Design

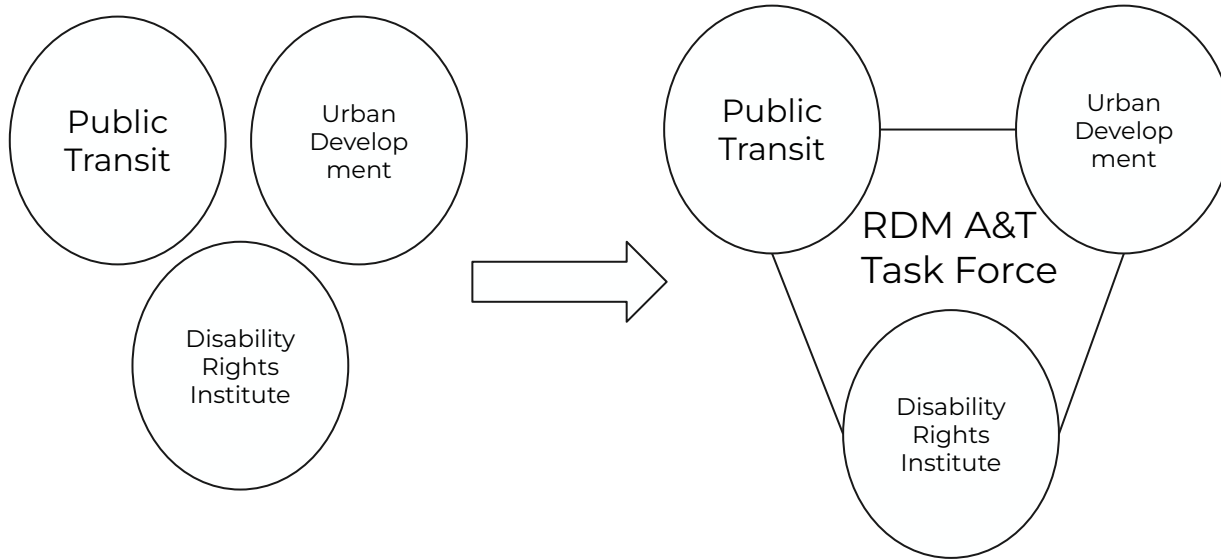
Storytelling and Characters





## Pillar 3: Admin Coordination

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# Pillar 4: Participation of Target Groups

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## Proposal and Challenges:

**Current Issue:** Disabled communities in Mexico are rarely consulted.

**Solution:** Directly design solutions to potential problems with the transit system with those that will be using it the most!

**Gaps/Challenges:** Distrust sabotages inclusion as these communities might not report issues or participate in town halls/panels if they feel that nothing will be done anyways.

**Recommendations:** Host public forums, send advocates to and from the community, and take special care to listen to grievances.

### Population that heard about corruption acts in Hidalgo 2015-2023

Published by [Jose Sanchez](#), Aug 6, 2024

 In 2023, the number of people whom someone told them about corruption acts in different procedures in Hidalgo increased by 7.6 thousand people per 100,000 inhabitants (+19.75 percent) since 2021. With 46.04 thousand people per 100,000 inhabitants, the number thereby reached its highest value in the observed period.

For more insights about the number of people whom someone told them about corruption acts in different procedures consider different countries: In 2023, in comparison to Hidalgo, the number in [Oaxaca](#) as well as in [Sonora](#) was higher.





# Pillar 5: Attitudes

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1. Fragmented Transit System



2. Legacy of Failed Reform



3. Cultural Barriers to Accessibility



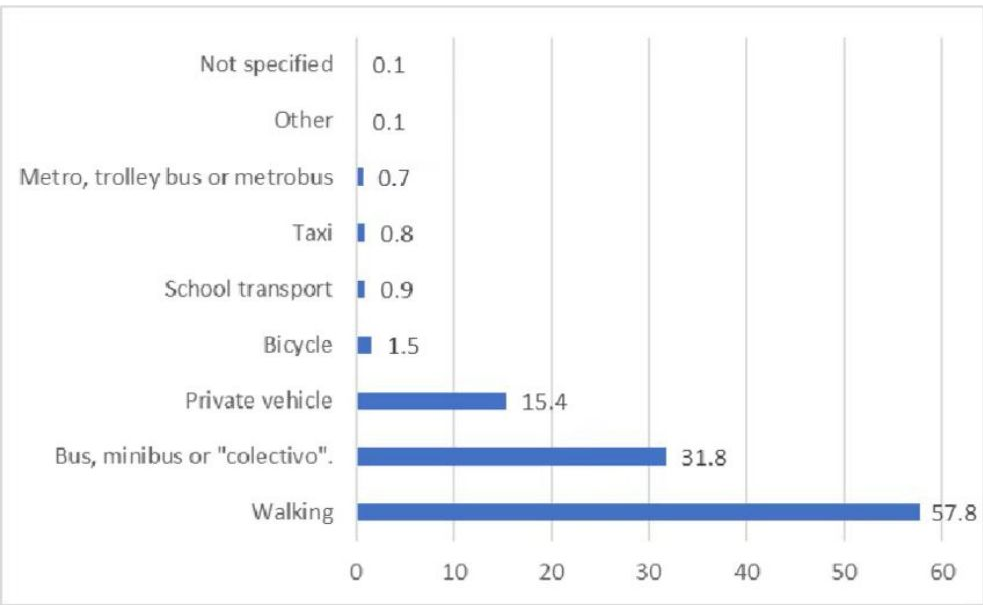
4. High Transit Dependency



5. Path Forward: Rebuilding Trust

# Pillar 5: Attitudes

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Percentage use of the means or mode of transport to school destinations of the population aged three years and over in the state of Hidalgo

| Number of concessions    | Total | Percentage |
|--------------------------|-------|------------|
| More than 10 concessions | 6     | 0.08%      |
| 6-10 concessions         | 5     | 0.07%      |
| 5 concessions            | 46    | 0.61%      |
| 4 concessions            | 118   | 1.56%      |
| 3 concessions            | 307   | 4.07%      |
| 2 concessions            | 1075  | 14.25%     |
| 1 concession             | 5986  | 79.36%     |

Distribution of individual public transport concessions in the state of Hidalgo

**\*CONCESSIONARY:** In the context of public transport (especially in places like Mexico), a concessionary refers to a private individual or company that has been granted a legal right (a "concession") by the government to operate a specific service, such as running a bus line or route.



## Group 5 x Felipe Estrada

*Image was AI generated through Chat GPT*

**Felipe's redefined life with independence and freedom:**

- Accessibility Ramp
- Independence and Freedom
- Cobblestone x Transit
- Handles & Bars
- Expand his travels past the Plaza and Church
- Inclusivity

*( **Visual Description:** The image to the left shows an AI drawing of an Felipe Estrada going onto an accessibility bus in Real Del Monte. The bus includes an accessibility ramp which supports him and his disability. The transit works with the road's cobblestone, leading to an independent life for Felipe.*



# Appendix 1

1. The main barrier persons with disabilities in Mexico faced was a lack of accessibility on streets, buildings, and transport; 31.9% in a 2022 survey. Currently, in Mexico, there are not enough elements for people with disabilities to have access to the necessary infrastructure and equipment in public spaces; This implies that those who suffer from some combination of disabilities (visual, auditory, motor, and intellectual) in different degrees and combinations enjoy a lower degree of participation in society because the structural context lacks special adaptations.
2. Pachuca features cobblestone streets and uneven sidewalks, difficulties for individuals using wheelchairs or walkers. Additionally, many buildings lack elevators or ramps, limiting access to their interiors.
3. The city is known for its culture and community, but actively excludes one source of community, by not taking into account inclusion and accessibility in most spaces.
4. Those who suffer from a combination of disabilities enjoy a lower degree of participation in society because the structural context lacks special adaptations
5. Mexicans with disabilities are 28% less likely to complete primary school, 62% less likely to finish a university education, and 32% more likely to be unemployed. The city/town is known for its culture and community, but actively excludes one great source of community, by not taking into account inclusion and accessibility in most spaces.
6. 49.6% of people report being discriminated against because of their disability (International Labour Organization).
7. With such a huge population that is disabled in this city, there needs to be more attention to this humanitarian problem. Not only is this community having to deal with physical barriers but they are also being denied their basic human rights to the city and space whenever they are judged for being there or can't even move through a space.
8. Pachuca is a city within Hidalgo, Mexico, and is the state's capital. At its peak it was the biggest producer of silver for all of Mexico, making it fairly well known and apparent to the media and general public. Within it is Real Del Monte, a Pueblo (town) located in Pachuca (east-central) and one of 84 municipalities. Like its larger city, it holds deep ties to the mining industry, producing some of the most silver and ore imaginable. Many natives refer to Real Del Monte as a Pueblo Mágico, a magical town, which is a title given to it by the Mexican government, recognizing it for its 'magical' ties to culture, history, etc.
9. Mexico is known for its culture and community, but actively excludes one source of community, by not taking into account inclusion and accessibility in most spaces.
10. Possible Solutions
  - a. 1. Pedestrian Accessibility
    - i. Invest in sidewalk reconstruction
    - ii. Install more multisensory signage, warnings
    - iii. Clear possible barriers on existing sidewalks and paths
    - iv. Crosswalks at every intersection
  - b. Lack of accessible public transportation
    - i. Propose a robust public transportation system to reduce vehicle dependence and thus reduces the number of vehicles blocking the street
    - ii. Encourage participation from the public to make the vehicles and bus stops accessible, timely, and efficient through community meetings or digital surveys
    - iii. Build a transit app so that buses are held responsible to their schedule and to build public trust in the reliability of the new system.
    - iv. Create convenience in public transportation with accessible infrastructures on all transportation vehicles – ramp on bus, no gap between boarding vehicle, larger space in vehicle for wheelchairs



# Appendix 2

1. Avenida Hidalgo
  - a. Often dubbed the “Core Artery of Real del Monte”, the street “Avenida Hidalgo” crosses centrally through the entire city and often is a bustling area with businesses and vendors lining the street.
2. Inaccessibility in its Design
  - a. The aesthetic and popular street of Avenida Hidalgo is stunning, however, heavily inaccessible. The streets are made of cobblestone, there are no curb cuts, nor any Public transportation options, forcing patrons to have to either drive personal cars or walk to successfully move through the space.
3. Coalition Building and Advocacy:
  - a. Municipal Government and Presidente Municipal, these are key figures responsible for policy making and are necessary for legislative changes and enforcement.
  - b. Safe Mobility Coalition: Intensive 97 civil society organizations and specialists with greater experience and resources to push legislative efforts.
  - c. Liga Peatonal (Pedestrian League): Organization of individuals interested in changing cities to make them accessible to all through walkability and pedestrianization.
  - d. Stakeholders: Appeal to interest of local community who may also benefit, the disabled community, parents, the elderly, active walkers, etc.
4. Competing Interests:
  - a. Local Business and Historical Preservationists: It is important to clearly address the concerns with the historic background of the city in our proposal. Engaging historic and culturally sensitive expertise in our redesign. Also emphasize that investment in accessibility will improve business.
  - b. Contractors and Builders: The addition of standards and codes may find new regulations daunting, to address this we must clearly define our standards and provide resources.
  - c. Financial Allocations and Alternative Priorities: With many competing issues in which finances can alternatively be relocated we ought to emphasize our project as a long term investment in both welfare and economic development that comes with improved transportation and infrastructure.
5. Proposal and Challenges:
  - a. Current Issue in Real Del Monte: Many of the current agencies (transportation, urban planning, social services, and housing authority) are not working in tandem with each other. They operate independently without collaboration or communication. No agency in Real Del Monte is fully accountable for accessibility, leading to solutions that are more or less “patchwork”
  - b. Solution: Establishing a committee that connects all of the related agencies (such as the ones mentioned previously) with disability representatives. Connecting with each other is the first step, the second step is connecting with the community to understand their wants and needs. A cross agency collaboration/committee “RDM (Real Del Monte) Accessibility Task Force” should be created, one that bridges the gap between not only the agencies themselves, but also between the government and the wider community.
  - c. Gaps/Challenges: Difficulty convincing everyone that this is important and should be dealt with first as opposed the other problems that Mexico as a whole might already be facing. Bureaucratic delays are often the demise of public policy and urban projects as funds and support will dwindle the longer a project takes to start.
  - d. Recommendations: Representatives from agencies and community meet monthly, use joint budgets to fund projects, set goals such as clear KPI's, and use shared metrics to track progress.

# Appendix 3

1. Proposal and Challenges:
  - a. Current Issue in Pachuca: Disabled communities in Mexico are rarely consulted. How are you going to solve a problem for someone if you don't understand their point of view and their problems?
  - b. Solution: This is directly tied to Pillar 3, once you have agencies working together, then you can begin working with the community. Directly design solutions to accessibility problems with those that need it most: disability groups! Speak with them, look at the city through their lens, and most importantly hear and understand them. Reach out not only to representatives of disability groups, but also citizens going about their daily lives. This includes everyone, not only those with disabilities. See how everyone feels about accessibility. Garnering public support is essential to getting any urban policy passed.
  - c. Gaps/Challenges: The biggest challenge is convincing people to trust that the government is trying to help them. Historically, the Mexican government does not have the best reputation for trustworthiness as it is often found to be corrupt. Distrust sabotages disability inclusion as disabled communities might not report issues or participate in town halls/panels if they feel that nothing will be done anyways.
  - d. Recommendations: Host public forums as an organization with interpreters to encourage participation from everyone, send advocates to and from disability groups, take special care to listen to grievances and act upon them to build trust in the community.
2. Real del Monte, with a specific focus on its central core street “Avenida Hidalgo”, may be absolutely stunning in its aesthetic, but the popular tourist area is heavily inaccessible due to its fragmented sidewalks, uneven cobblestone floors, lack of curb ramps along with no visual and tactile cues, and steep streets. The inaccessibility is further heightened by the city not having any dependable nor accessible public transportation system, which perpetuates an expectation that community members will need to walk through the street to access it successfully. Individuals with mobility or cognitive impairments like our target persona Lucia are severely limited in their ability to navigate the town and the current design and public infrastructure of the street reinforces the exclusion of disabled individuals from civic, cultural, and everyday community life.
3. Mexico is known for its culture and community, but actively excludes one source of community, by not taking into account inclusion and accessibility in most spaces.
4. Organizations and Advocacies:
  - a. Safe Mobility Coalition: Intensive 97 civil society organizations and specialists with greater experience and resources to push legislative efforts. Passed Bill in 2020 making safe travel a constitutional right. Advocates for safe travel through legal means
  - b. Liga Peatonal (Pedestrian League): Organization of individuals interested in changing cities to make them accessible to all through walkability and pedestrianization. Examples of the usage of Urban Acupuncture in their usage of graffiti to reclaim intersections. Hosts “Pedestrian Congress” a meeting event for people to share ideas and connect with those who care about expanding mobility rights and sustainability.
  - c. Global Policy: UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (Ratified by Mexico)
  - d. NOM: Mandatory standards regarding quality of products from appliances, foods, equipment, environment, and construction. However sidewalks are not subject to these standards and are often constructed and designed by contractors which results in walkways of varying sizes and quality.
  - e. Mexico General Law for the Inclusion of People with Disabilities (2011), Article 19. The Ministry of Communications and Transportation shall promote the right of persons with disabilities, without discrimination of any kind, to access transportation, information and communications systems and technologies, particularly those that contribute to their independence and comprehensive development. To this end, it shall carry out the following actions:
  - f. Law for the Care of People with Disabilities in the State of Hidalgo (1998):ARTICLE 36 - Persons with disabilities have the right to access to means of transportation through preferential spaces designated for this purpose in the various means of public transport; and preferential parking areas for vehicles carrying disabled people. There will be one parking space for every twenty vehicles carrying disabled people. These spaces will be closest to the entrances and exits to the vehicle or to establishments providing this service. The city councils in the area must adapt their regulations in this regard.



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# Pillar 3: Admin Coordination

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## Proposal and Challenges:

**Current Issue in Real Del Monte:** Many of the current agencies are not working in tandem with each other.

**Solution:** A cross agency collaboration/committee “RDM (Real Del Monte) Accessibility & Transit Task Force” should be created.

**Gaps/Challenges:** Bureaucratic delays are often the demise of public policy and urban projects as funds and support will dwindle the longer a project takes to start.

**Recommendations:** Representatives from agencies and community meet monthly, use joint budgets to fund projects, set goals such as clear KPI's, and use shared metrics to track progress.





# Pillar 4: Participation of Target Groups

## Proposal and Challenges:

**Current Issue in Pachuca:** Disabled communities in Mexico are rarely consulted. How are you going to solve a problem for someone if you don't understand their point of view and their problems?

**Solution:** This is directly tied to Pillar 3, once you have agencies working together, then you can begin working with the community. Directly design solutions to accessibility problems with those that need it most: disability groups! Speak with them, look at the city through their lens, and most importantly hear and understand them. Reach out not only to representatives of disability groups, but also citizens going about their daily lives. This includes everyone, not only those with disabilities. See how everyone feels about accessibility. Garnering public support is essential to getting any urban policy passed.

**Gaps/Challenges:** The biggest challenge is convincing people to trust that the government is trying to help them. Historically, the Mexican government does not have the best reputation for trustworthiness as it is often found to be corrupt. Distrust sabotages disability inclusion as disabled communities might not report issues or participate in town halls/panels if they feel that nothing will be done anyways.

**Recommendations:** Host public forums as an organization with interpreters to encourage participation from everyone, send advocates to and from disability groups, take special care to listen to grievances and act upon them to build trust in the community.

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# Pillar 3: Admin Coordination

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## Proposal and Challenges:



**Current Issue in Real Del Monte:** Many of the current agencies (transportation, urban planning, social services, and housing authority) are not working in tandem with each other. They operate independently without collaboration or communication. No agency in Real Del Monte is fully accountable for accessibility, leading to solutions that are more or less “patchwork”

**Solution:** Establishing a committee that connects all of the related agencies (such as the ones mentioned previously) with disability representatives. Connecting with each other is the first step, the second step is connecting with the community to understand their wants and needs. A cross agency collaboration/committee “RDM (Real Del Monte) Accessibility Task Force” should be created, one that bridges the gap between not only the agencies themselves, but also between the government and the wider community.

**Gaps/Challenges:** Difficulty convincing everyone that this is important and should be dealt with first as opposed the other problems that Mexico as a whole might already be facing. Bureaucratic delays are often the demise of public policy and urban projects as funds and support will dwindle the longer a project takes to start.

**Recommendations:** Representatives from agencies and community meet monthly, use joint budgets to fund projects, set goals such as clear KPI’s, and use shared metrics to track progress.

# Pillar 5: Attitudes

CYPLAN 120

## Proposal and Challenges:

**Current Issue in Pachuca:** Disabled communities are often excluded from consultation, making it hard to address their real needs effectively.

**Solution:** Work directly with disability groups to co-create accessibility solutions. Understand their daily experiences and build public support by involving the broader community.

**Gaps/Challenges:** Widespread distrust in government, due to a history of corruption, prevents people from engaging in inclusive efforts or reporting issues.

**Recommendations:** Organize public forums with interpreters, send advocates to and from disability communities, and follow through on feedback to rebuild trust.





## Target Persona: “Lucia”

*Image was AI generated through ChatGPT*

### Key Attributes for Consideration:

- 65 years old
- Limited Mobility and a Wheelchair user
- Experiencing Mild Cognitive Decline
- Avid patron of the Church and market on Avenida Hidalgo
- Struggles with the inaccessible cobblestone floors and lack of public transportation

*( **Visual Description:** The image to the left shows a sketch drawing of an elderly woman with greying hair and grim expression on her face moving through Avenida Hidalgo on a wheelchair. There is a church in the background, a street market to her left upon a slightly elevated sidewalk. )*



# Inequality should not be accepted!

CYPLAN 120

- Denial of basic rights to the city places by abled body individuals
  - Less work, less access, less resources, more challenges
- Discrimination and ignorance is a norm
- New plans are needed to prioritize people with a disability
- The city is known for its culture and community, but actively excludes one source of community, by not taking into account inclusion and accessibility in most spaces.

**Those who suffer from a combination of disabilities enjoy a lower degree of participation in society because the structural context lacks special adaptations**



# Possible Solutions

CYPLAN 120

## 1. Pedestrian Accessibility

- 1) Invest in sidewalk reconstruction
- 2) Install more multisensory signage, warnings
- 3) Clear possible barriers on existing sidewalks and paths
- 4) Crosswalks at every intersection





Mexico is known for its culture and community, but actively excludes one source of community, by not taking into account inclusion and accessibility in most spaces.

### Avenida Hidalgo

( **Visual Description:** The image to the top right is a map of Real De Monte rendered in Google Maps' dark mode with the Avenue in question highlighted in bright blue)

Often dubbed the “**Core Artery** of Real del Monte”, the street “Avenida Hidalgo” crosses centrally through the entire city and often is a **bustling area** with businesses and vendors lining the street.

### Inaccessibility in its Design

( **Visual Description:** The image to the bottom right depicts an early morning on Hidalgo Avenue, with a few cars parked to the side of the street near the buildings. The buildings are roughly two to three stories tall and line both sides of the street. The floors are made of cobblestone)

The aesthetic and popular street of Avenida Hidalgo is stunning, however, **heavily inaccessible**. The streets are made of **cobblestone**, there are **no curb cuts**, **nor any Public transportation** options, forcing patrons to have to either drive personal cars or walk to successfully move through the space.

